



MLAs DISRUPT HOUSE PROCEEDINGS WITH THEIR UNRULY BEHAVIOUR

Bleak HOUSE

It meets infrequently, and when it does, the members use it to settle political scores rather than legislate. The Assembly is turning into a rubberstamp for the executive.

By Subhash Mishra

Senior BJP leader Om Prakash Singh is not a happy man these days. He boycotted all the sessions of the Business Advisory Committee of the state Assembly in February. That was his way of voicing his dissent over the reduction of days for discussing the Budget from 13 days to eight, and then finally to just three. "This is clearly a mockery of parliamentary protocol and traditions. The ruling party (BSP) wants to cripple the functioning of the House. If it does

not want to run the Assembly, it should order its closure," Singh told INDIA TODAY. "Even when the Assembly is functioning, Chief Minister Mayawati and Leader of the Opposition Shivpal Singh Yadav are rarely seen in it."

Despite being the Leader of the House, Mayawati has attended its sessions only about five times, and that too only on important occasions like the Governor's Address or the budget announcement. "The quality of the debate, personalised comments by the members of the Opposition and ugly scenes during

sessions might be the reason behind the reduced presence of the Leader of the House and Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly," says Speaker Sukhdev Rajbhar.

Mayawati doesn't even go to her office at Lal Bahadur Shastri Bhawan, and conducts all her work from her residence at 5, Kalidas Marg. The daily affairs of the state are in the hands of her trusted bureaucrats while Mayawati stays busy in political management and planning the expansion of her party. Perhaps that is why she doesn't have any time to attend the Assembly sessions.